ShodhSetu

RESEARCH TO CAREER

We turn students into researchers. Through mentored AI research projects run by active IIT researchers, students build real work and a strong profile for research internships, higher studies and AI jobs.

Our objective

- Bridge academia and industry for Indian students
- Every student leaves with a GitHub repo, a paper-style report and a talk
- Prepare students to win research internships and AI roles
- Promise preparation, never a guaranteed seat

Where we focus: our niches

1 Indian-document AI
OCR and verification for Indian-language documents. Industry needs it; few teach it.

2 Internship applicants
SRIP, GRISHMA, RISE UP, Uplink, MITACS, DAAD WISE. Clear goal and deadline.

3 MS / PhD aspirants
Need research experience and strong letters.

4 GATE DA aspirants
Theory they already study, made real with projects.

5 Final-year projects
Sold to colleges as a guided program for a batch.

Products and pricing (to test)

PRODUCT	WHAT	PRICE
Free	YouTube, webinars, paper-reading guide	**₹0**
Starter	Recorded mini course, 1 to 2 weeks	**₹499–999**
Pilot cohort	6 weeks live, team research project	**₹2,999–4,999**
Research Track	8 to 10 weeks, mentor reviews, paper, talk, application kit	**₹9,999–14,999**
Research Pro	One-on-one mentoring and submission support	**₹24,999–39,999**
Colleges (B2B)	Batch program or 2-day workshop	**Per batch**

Early-bird prices, EMI for higher tiers, a few scholarships per cohort. Raise prices only when results improve.

Founders: who owns what

Shikhar

Co-founder, Academics and Content

- Curriculum and research projects
- Videos and YouTube
- Academic network and speakers
- Mentoring and paper reviews

Sanhita

Co-founder, Product and Growth

- Website and student dashboard
- Workshops, webinars, sales
- College partnerships
- Student success and community

Together: weekly founder meeting, shared numbers, a written founders' agreement.

What Shikhar learns

- **First:** teaching on camera, scripting, OBS and DaVinci Resolve
- **Maths:** linear algebra (3Blue1Brown, Strang 18.06), probability (Stat 110), optimisation, "Mathematics for ML"
- **AI:** Karpathy Zero to Hero, fast.ai, CS231n, OCR and document AI, Hugging Face
- **Research confidence:** 2 papers a week, reproduce 2, submit 1 workshop paper
- **Startup:** "The Mom Test", YC Startup School

What Sanhita learns

- **Web for the startup:** Next.js, Supabase, Razorpay, mobile-first landing page, student dashboard
- **AI path:** LLM apps and RAG, then fast.ai and Karpathy, then the maths
- **Become an AI scientist:** reproduce one paper, then own research in web + AI (browser-based document AI, human-in-the-loop labelling)
- **Growth:** community, outreach, partnerships, simple finance

Tech we use

- **Now:** YouTube, Notion, Razorpay, Discord, Google Meet
- **Teaching:** Python, PyTorch, Hugging Face, Colab, GitHub, Overleaf
- **Soon:** Next.js + Supabase site with project tracker
- **Later:** AI feedback on code and drafts, leaderboards

Roadmap to a large company

Months 0–3
Name, site, 4–6 videos, 2 webinars, 20 student interviews, pilot cohort of 20–30

Months 3–6
Demo day, testimonials, Research Track launch, register company, join an incubator

Months 6–18
3–5 alumni TAs, 2–3 tracks (vision/OCR, NLP, GenAI), college partnerships

18 months +
Paid PhD mentor network across institutes, B2B programs, own AI-powered platform

What makes us very good

- Real research problems, taught by people doing research right now
- Small cohorts with weekly mentor feedback
- Public student showcase: every project is proof for the next cohort
- Talk to 3 students a week each; build what they ask for
- Check PhD side-venture rules before charging; don't use IIT names or logos
- Research ethics: students do their own work, only licensed data
- Fixed founder hours; protect PhD and exam time
- One niche, one track, one channel for the first 90 days

Numbers we track every Sunday

Signups · Paid students · Completion rate · Reports finished · Interviews and offers · Money in vs out · Would recommend us